

Lagos, Nigeria

June 09, 2026

TO: Admissions Committee — PhD Programme in Information Systems, University of Salford

FROM: Chizoba Nzeakor, Co-Founder & CEO — Climate Technology Solutions

RE: Letter of Recommendation — Stanley Chukwuebuka Okonkwo, PhD in Information Systems, University of Salford

DATE: June 09, 2026

I am pleased to recommend Stanley Chukwuebuka Okonkwo for the PhD programme in Information Systems at the University of Salford. I am the founder of Climate Technology Solutions, and Stanley has worked with us on environmental analytics and community engagement programmes focused on gully erosion remediation, sustainable land management, and environmental awareness in southeastern Nigeria. What makes him exceptional for an Information Systems programme is not only his technical capability but his understanding of the gap that IS research must close: the distance between data that exists and information that gets used.

Gully erosion in southeastern Nigeria is a problem with abundant data and almost no usable information infrastructure. The satellite imagery, the field measurements, the GIS analyses exist. What consistently fails is the system that would make that information accessible, interpretable, and actionable for the local government officials, community leaders, and field workers who need it to make decisions. Stanley worked in exactly that gap. His GIS analysis and spatial modelling of erosion extent were rigorous and well-executed, but the contribution I valued most was his ability to understand what information different stakeholders needed, in what form, and through what channels.

In planning sessions that brought together community elders, local government officials, and technical specialists, he consistently found ways to synthesise those perspectives into action plans that all parties felt genuine ownership over. He understood that effective information systems in this context are as much about trust and institutional fit as they are about technical design. That understanding is precisely what distinguishes IS research that produces tools people actually use from research that produces tools that sit on servers.

Stanley's doctoral research on AI-driven geospatial information systems for urban flood risk monitoring is a direct extension of the work we have done together, applied at the metropolitan scale. The methodological depth he would develop at Salford, in system design, organisational IS, and data architecture, would make him significantly more effective in designing information systems that bridge environmental science and governance practice in West African cities. I recommend him without reservation.

Warm regards,



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